

FOSTER SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

UNIVERSITY OF WASHINGTON

**ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR CONSULTING
PROJECT REPORT**

 *Member Engagement and Commitment*

MGMT 300 – ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOR

BY







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SEATTLE, WASHINGTON

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Section One: Executive Summary

Our report focuses on analyzing organizational behavior in [REDACTED], a student club here at the University of Washington. We got survey results from 24 past and current [REDACTED] club members in order to find out more information about organizational strengths, weaknesses, and retention problems.

Members of [REDACTED] have generally favorable views of the club. Our survey had high overall reliability among its various questions, which shows us that there is a lot of agreement and shared club sentiment among members. [REDACTED]

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Section Two: Introduction

2.1 Overview

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2.2 History

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2.4 Organizational Structure

A vertical sequence of 12 horizontal bars. The bars vary in length and pattern. From top to bottom: 1. A solid black bar. 2. A cross-hatched bar. 3. A solid black bar. 4. A cross-hatched bar. 5. A solid black bar. 6. A cross-hatched bar. 7. A solid black bar. 8. A cross-hatched bar. 9. A solid black bar. 10. A cross-hatched bar. 11. A solid black bar. 12. A cross-hatched bar. The bars are arranged in a vertical sequence, with some bars being longer than others, creating a stepped effect.

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Section Three: Methodology

3.1 Theoretical Framework

Our survey was based on five constructs from organizational behavior topics covered in class, as well as topics from our own separate research. First, we wanted to look at respondent's emotional attachment to the club (how connected and "part of the family" people feel). This builds on Meyer and Allen's (1991) model of why people stay in organizations. Second, we wanted to measure respondent's identification with the club's values, which is how much members agree with what the club stands for. Third, we included questions on satisfaction and intent to stay, to see if members enjoy the club and plan to keep showing up. Fourth, we included questions on leadership quality and regular members' views on how club officers have been performing. Finally, we wanted to measure community and cohesion, being how well members get along and welcome each other.

3.2 Sample and Procedure

We sent an anonymous Google Forms survey to the club's current members and recent alumni. We received 24 complete responses, including five first-year students, seven second-year students, seven third-year students, three fourth-year students, and two alumni. Eight of the respondents are officers; sixteen are general members. The tenure distribution is: one member with fewer than one quarter, twelve with one to three quarters, six with four to seven quarters, and five with eight or more quarters.

3.3 Survey

The survey contains twenty-four Likert questions rated on a five-point scale (1 = strongly disagree, 5 = strongly agree), five questions asking about demographics and behavioral engagement, and then five open-ended questions. The question categories were grouped into five conceptual groups before we collected the data. After we received the data, the scores of the quantitative Likert questions were calculated as the mean of replies within each group, and qualitative responses from the open-ended questions were reviewed manually.

3.4 Statistical Methods

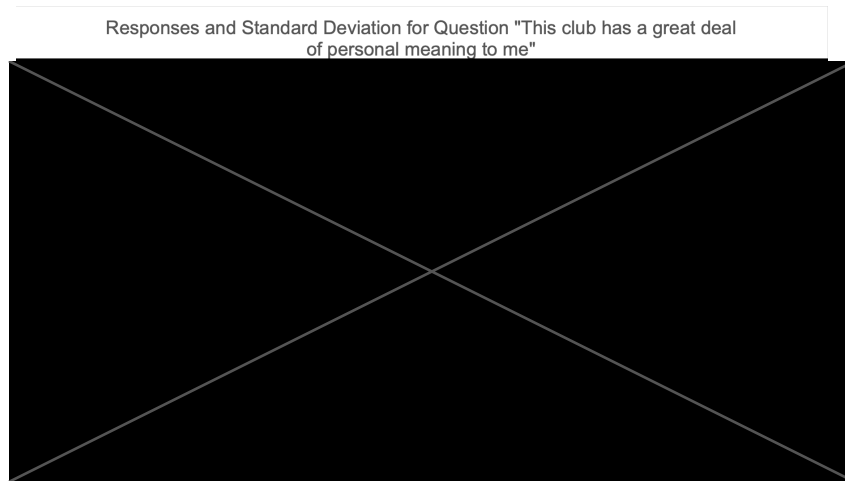
We did the majority of our analysis in Excel, with some additional data analysis in Alteryx Designer. With the information collected from individual respondents, we knew we had to have a methodical way to analyze the large amount of data. We began by doing our own research on how to best look at this data, and we decided to use the following popular statistical tests to analyze the data and prove its own internal reliability.

3.4.1 Standard Deviation

Standard deviation measures how much the data spreads out from the mean. It shows how consistent the data is in relation to itself. To calculate the standard deviation, Excel offered an automated formula which we used: =STDEV(). The full equation, however, is as follows:

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^n (x_i - \bar{x})^2}{n-1}}$$

Visually, the standard deviation can be represented on a graph such as the one below, where the blue line represents the Likert form responses (1-5) on the horizontal axis and the number of respondents answering each value on the vertical axis, an averaged trendline in dotted blue, with standard deviation ranges (computed by Excel) in the black bars:



3.4.2 Reliability (Cronbach's Alpha)

Chronbach's Alpha checks whether the questions in a group are really measuring the same thing. σ_i^2 is the variance of one item across people, and σ_t^2 is the variance of the total score (sum of all scores) across the different people who responded. The formula is:

$$\alpha = \left(\frac{k}{k-1} \right) \times \left(1 - \frac{\sum \sigma_i^2}{\sigma_t^2} \right)$$

In this formula, k is the number of items in the construct, σ_i^2 is the variance of item i, and σ_t^2 is the variance of the sum across respondents. Values of $\alpha \geq 0.70$ are considered to be acceptable, ≥ 0.80 as good, and ≥ 0.90 as excellent (Nunnally, 1978).

3.4.3 Bivariate Association (Pearson's r)

Pearson's r measures how strongly two things move together, on a scale of -1 to 1. We also report a p-value, which is the chance that a relationship this strong could have happened by accident:

$$r = \frac{\sum(x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})}{\sqrt{\sum(x_i - \bar{x})^2 \times \sum(y_i - \bar{y})^2}}$$

We looked at statistical significance using the t-distribution with $(n - 2)$ degrees of freedom, where the formula is $t = \frac{r\sqrt{n-2}}{\sqrt{1-r^2}}$. The null hypothesis is $p = 0$. What the numbers mean:
 $r = 0.10$ small effect size, $= 0.30$ medium effect size, $= 0.50$ large effect sizes.

3.4.4 Group Comparison (Welch's t-Test)

Welch's t-test compares the average score of two groups (like officers vs. regular members) and tells us whether the difference is bigger than you'd expect by random chance:

$$t = \frac{M_1 - M_2}{\sqrt{\frac{s_1^2}{n_1} + \frac{s_2^2}{n_2}}}$$

Effect size was reported as Cohen's d using the pooled standard deviation:

$$d = \frac{M_1 - M_2}{SD_{pooled}}, \text{ where } SD_{pooled} = \sqrt{\frac{(n_1 - 1) \times s_1^2 + (n_2 - 1) \times s_2^2}{n_1 + n_2 - 2}}$$

Effect-size groupings: $d = 0.2$ small, $= 0.5$ medium, $= 0.8$ large (Cohen, 1988).

Section Four: Diagnoses of Key Issues

4.1 Reliability of the Survey

Before we can draw any conclusions, we need to make sure that the survey actually measures what we were intending for it to. According to our research on the best way to verify this, Cronbach's alpha is the standard check. Here are the scores for each group of questions and for the survey overall:

Construct	Items (k)	Cronbach's α	Interpretation
Affective Commitment	4	0.924	Excellent
Identification & Values	4	0.887	Good
Satisfaction & Retention	5	0.932	Excellent
Leadership Quality	6	0.957	Excellent
Community/Cohesion	5	0.851	Good
Overall (all 24 responses)	24	0.965	Excellent

Every group here passes the 0.7 threshold easily, and % score above 0.9. This means that when someone agreed with one question in a group, they also tended to agree with the others. The respondents were answering these questions coherently, and not just selecting random responses. This means that the survey data is internally reliable to itself.

4.2 Descriptive Findings

4.2.1 Construct-Level Averages

Each theme’s score is on the same 1-5 scale. The average score across the 24 responses is [redacted], which is mostly positive. But the themes are not equal:

Construct	Mean	SD	Rank
Satisfaction & Retention	[redacted]		
Identification & Values			
Leadership Quality			
Community/Cohesion			
Affective Commitment			

There’s a clear pattern here. [redacted]

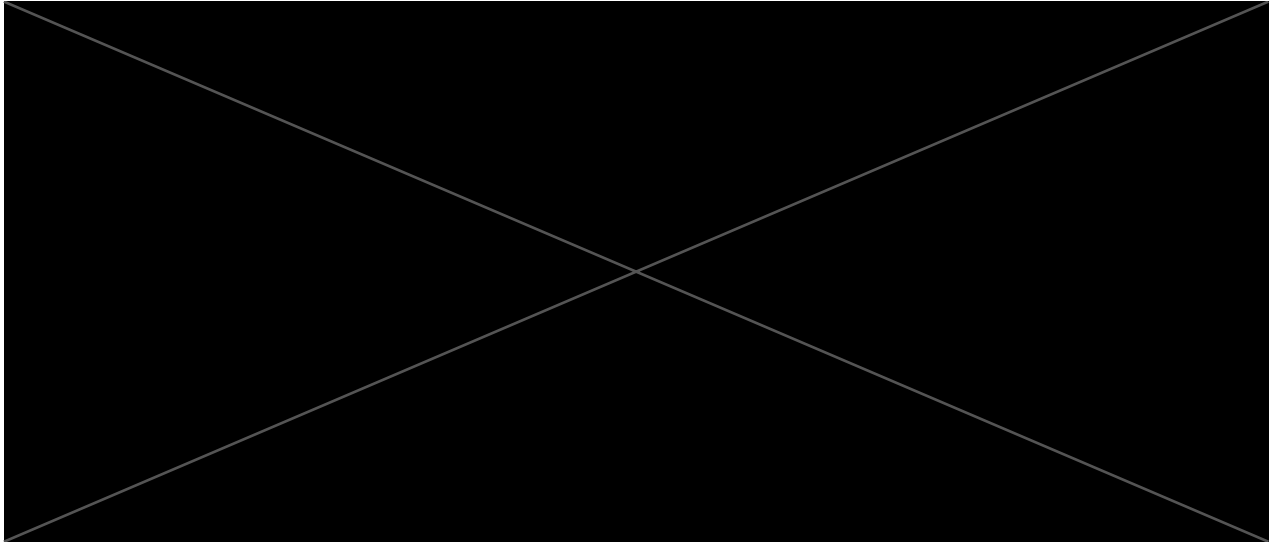
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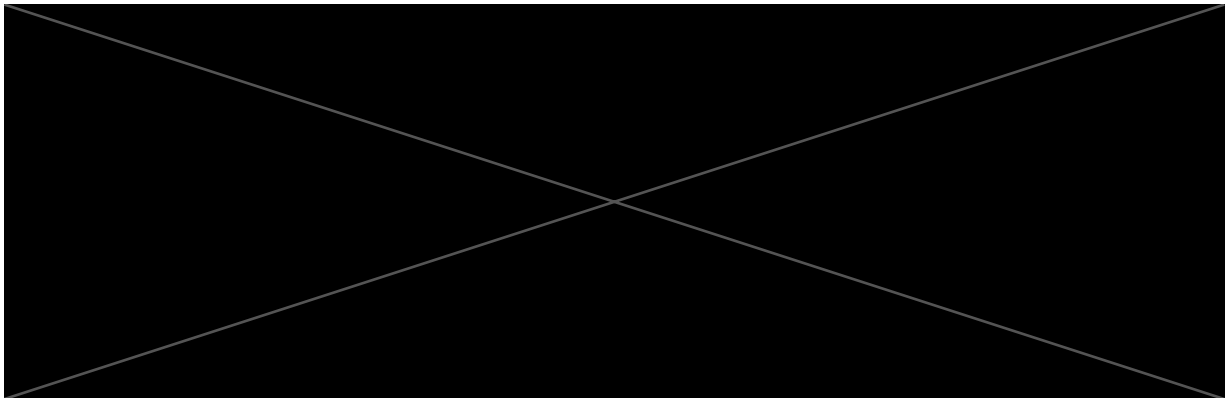
[redacted] This gap is the most important finding in our study and is examined in detail in section 4.5.

4.2.2 Highest and Lowest Rated Items

The five highest rated questions were:



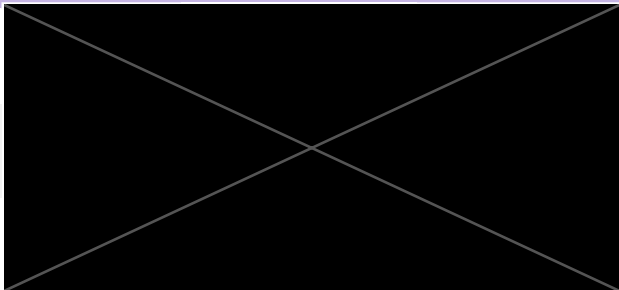
The five lowest-rated items are:



4.3 Inferential Findings

4.3.1 Engagement is What Predicts Club Sentiment

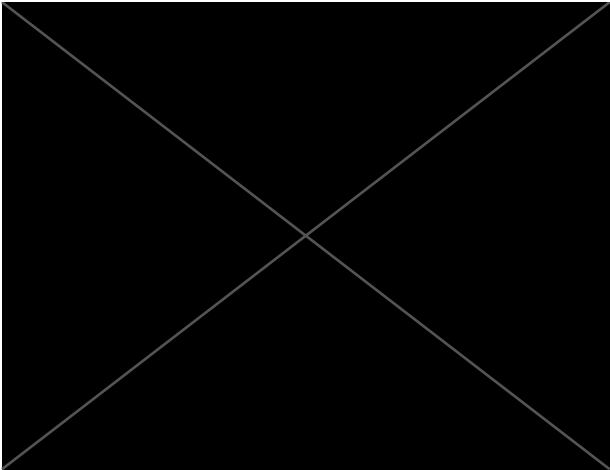
We compared two behavior measures (how often members come to the club meetings, and whether they’ve worked on ) against the survey scores overall. The relationships are strong, positive, and statistically significant.

Relationship	r	p	n
Attendance ↔ Overall sentiment			
Attendance ↔ Affective Commitment			
Production participation ↔ Overall sentiment			

All three relationships exceed the Cohen statistic for a large effect ($r > 0.50$) and all are statistically significant at the normal $\alpha = 0.05$ level. This means that these relationships are very unlikely to be a coincidence. The attendance/affective/commitment correlation is particularly strong: it explains over half ($r^2 = \text{ = \text{ = \text{$) of the variation of how people feel. The data doesn’t exactly tell us whether showing up to the meetings makes you feel attached or whether feeling attached makes you show up to the meetings (probably both), but the evidence linking them is extremely strong.

Leadership Quality and Retention

How members view their leaders is linked to almost everything else in the survey, but especially to whether the members plan to stay for next year:

Relationship	r	p	n
Leadership Quality ↔ Overall sentiment			
Leadership Quality ↔ Plan to remain			
Affective Commitment ↔ Plan to remain			
Affective Commitment ↔ Would recommend			
Community/Cohesion ↔ Plan to remain			

A simple model of retention based on leadership quality yields:

If you square $r = 0.71$ (leadership quality to plan to remain), you get

$r^2 = 0.50$ with $r^2 = 0.50$, this basically means that almost half of the variation in how much a person wants to stay with the club is accounted for by how they view the club leadership alone.

4.4 Qualitative Findings

Our survey had five open ended questions, and when we looked at the written responses, we had three themes come up over and over again. Each one matches a pattern in the numbers.

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4.5 Integrated Discussion

4.5.1 The Belonging Gap

The biggest takeaway from our survey is that [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

In Meyer and Allen's framework, [REDACTED]

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[REDACTED]

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[REDACTED]

4.5.2 [REDACTED]

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4.6 Limitations

While our data and findings are statistically solid, we want to acknowledge a few caveats and limitations to our data. First, our sample size of $n = 24$ is a small sample size, especially when you split the survey into subgroups (eg, regular member vs officer or split by year at UW). Second, because this is a one-time survey, we don't have any data on which way the cause runs (does showing up to club meetings make people feel attached, or does feeling attached make them show up?). Third, there's likely some self-selection bias, where members with strong opinions (in either direction) are more likely to fill out the survey and express those opinions, so there's a chance that those responses may be overrepresented at the extremes. Fourth, while we did have an anonymous survey sent out and results analyzed by a neutral third party individual not affiliated with the club in any way, the club is small enough that some respondents could have felt like club leaders may have attempted to guess who responded, which may have made respondents less forthcoming in their responses.

Section Five: Analysis Using Organizational Behavior

Frameworks

5.1 Overview

For the analysis of Organizational Behavior frameworks, we will first analyze the group mechanisms of leadership styles and team processes. Then we will examine the individual mechanisms of job satisfaction and ethics. Finally, we will see how group mechanisms and individual mechanisms result in the outcomes of affective commitment.

5.2 Group Mechanisms

In Organizational Behavior, group mechanisms are interpersonal structures of how individuals interact, work together, and function as a team.

5.2.1 Leadership Styles

Leadership styles are characterized by four transformative leadership behaviors: Idealized influence, inspirational motivation, intellectual stimulation, and individualized consideration.



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[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

5.2.2 Team Processes



5.3 Individual Mechanisms

Individual mechanisms are a person's own psychological or physical processes that influence their performance and commitment. In this section, we will analyze two individual mechanisms: Job satisfaction and Ethics.

5.3.1 Job Satisfaction

Job satisfaction is the degree to which an individual is satisfied with their job depends on the value-perception theory and the three psychological states of satisfying work.

The value-perception theory argues that job satisfaction depends on whether or not an individual perceives their job provides them with things that they value. The survey responses strongly indicated that members aligned with the club's values and mission statement. Members

also strongly value the skills and experiences they have gained from the club, which makes their participation more fulfilling.

The three psychological states of satisfying work are meaningfulness of work, responsibility for outcomes, and knowledge of results. Club members have the opportunity to work on what they enjoy. The skills and experience they gain are important to them, resulting in meaningful work. However, is less effective at providing members with responsibility for club outcomes.



5.4 Affective Commitment Outcomes

When we examine the organizational commitment outcomes, we found affective commitment to be the strongest factor, in both positive and negative ways. Affective commitment is loyalty to an organization based on emotional reasons. Members who had the strongest commitment were motivated by affective factors. Members who had the least commitment lacked affective factors. We will examine what makes members committed, and what marginalizes members based on affective commitment.

5.4.1 Strengths



[Redacted text block containing 10 lines of content]

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5.5 Conclusions

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[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Section Six: Recommendations

After looking through all the data from the survey we found five interventions that would improve or be helpful for [REDACTED]. [REDACTED] [REDACTED]

[REDACTED] We tried to tie each recommendation to what we have learned and also keep them realistic enough for a volunteer officer board to go through with. We picked these specific recommendations because our data showed that [REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Recommendation 1: [REDACTED]

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Recommendation 3:

A horizontal bar chart consisting of 15 bars. Each bar is filled with a black and white cross-hatch pattern. The bars are arranged in a non-sequential order, with the longest bar at the bottom and the shortest near the top. The bars vary in length, with some being nearly full-width and others being significantly shorter. The bars are arranged in a non-sequential order, with the longest bar at the bottom and the shortest near the top. The bars vary in length, with some being nearly full-width and others being significantly shorter. The bars are arranged in a non-sequential order, with the longest bar at the bottom and the shortest near the top. The bars vary in length, with some being nearly full-width and others being significantly shorter.

Recommendation 5: [REDACTED]

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Section Seven: Implementation Challenges

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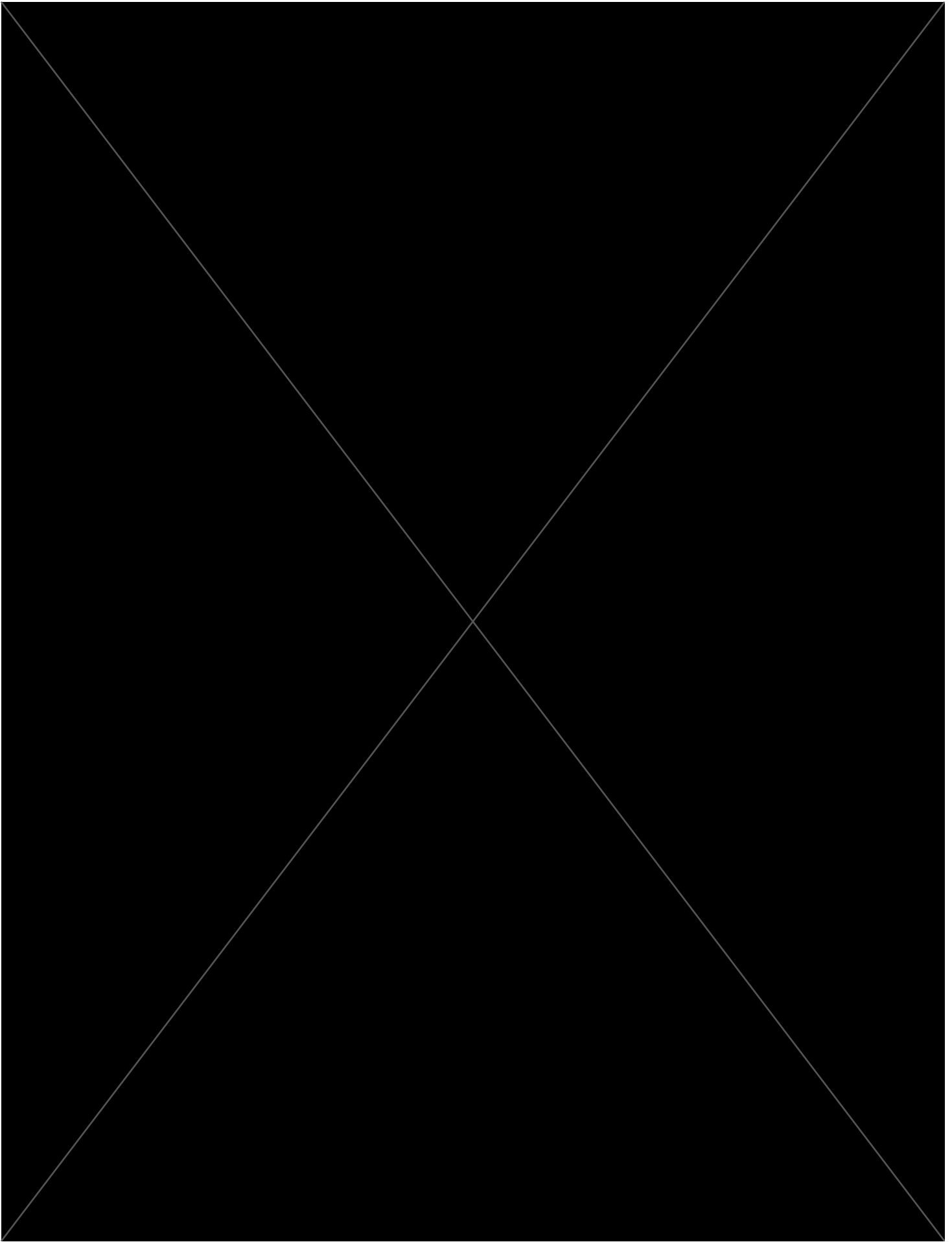
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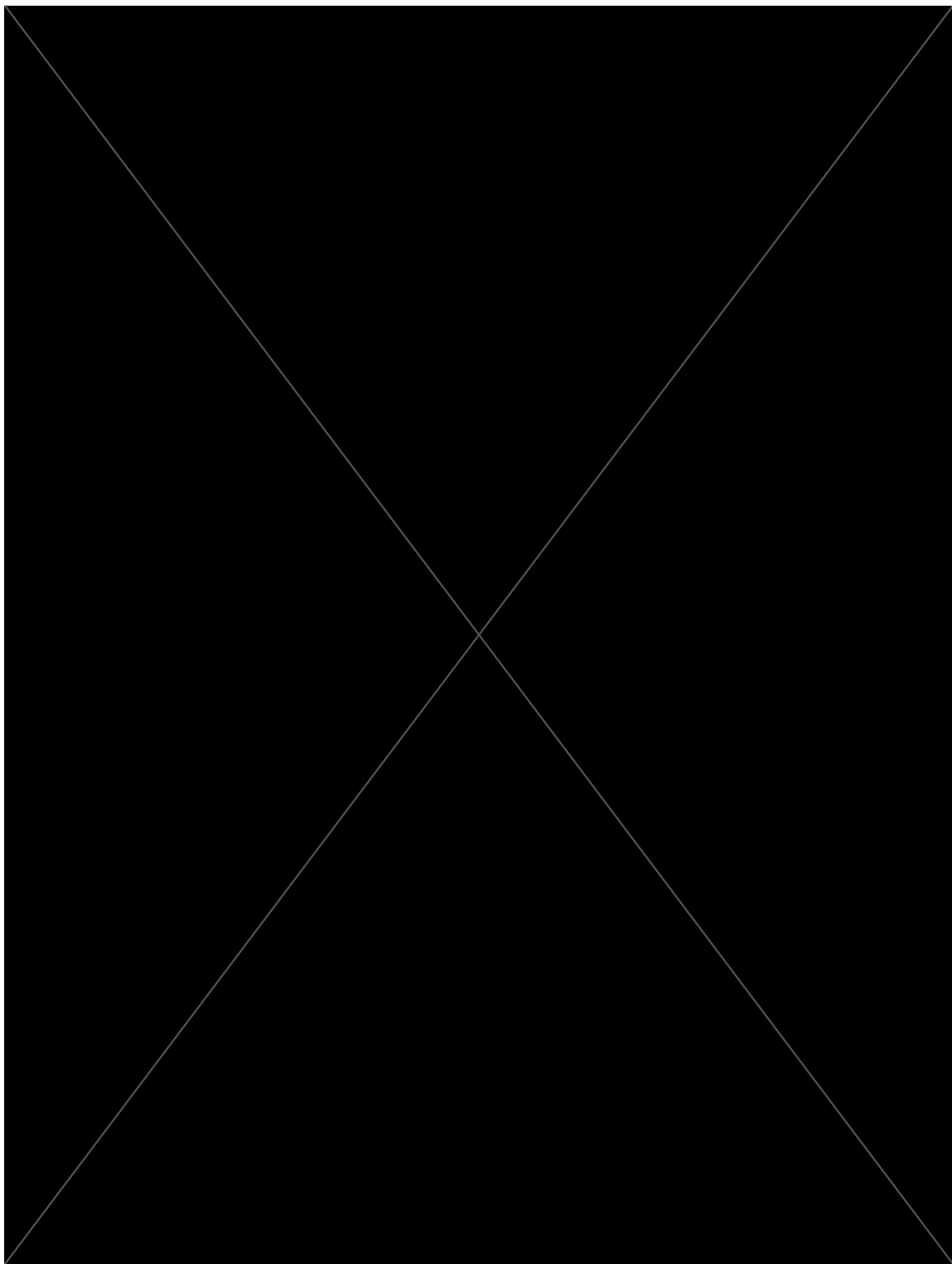
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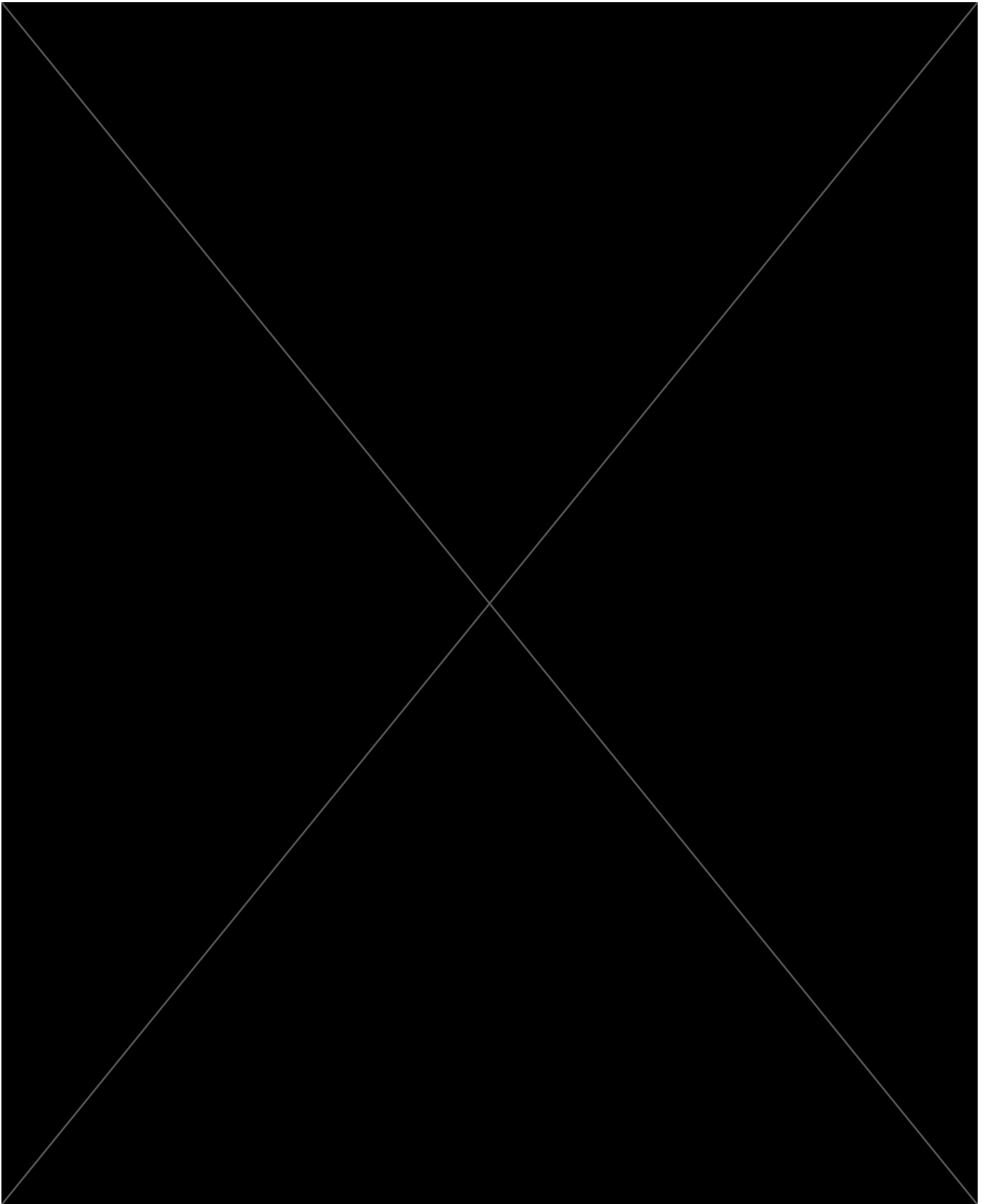
Section Eight: Conclusion

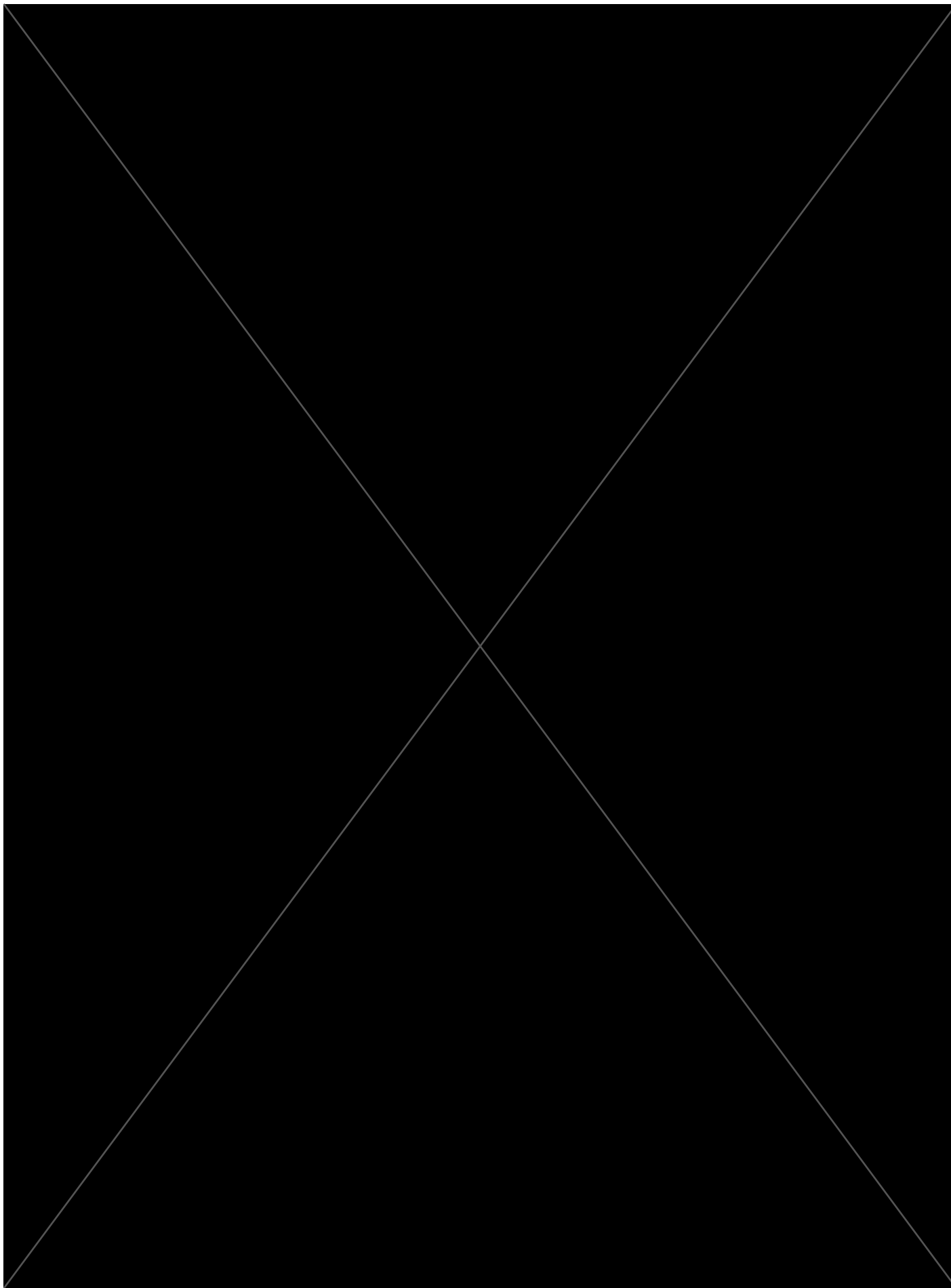
 has a lot of strengths regardless of the lower scores discussed.

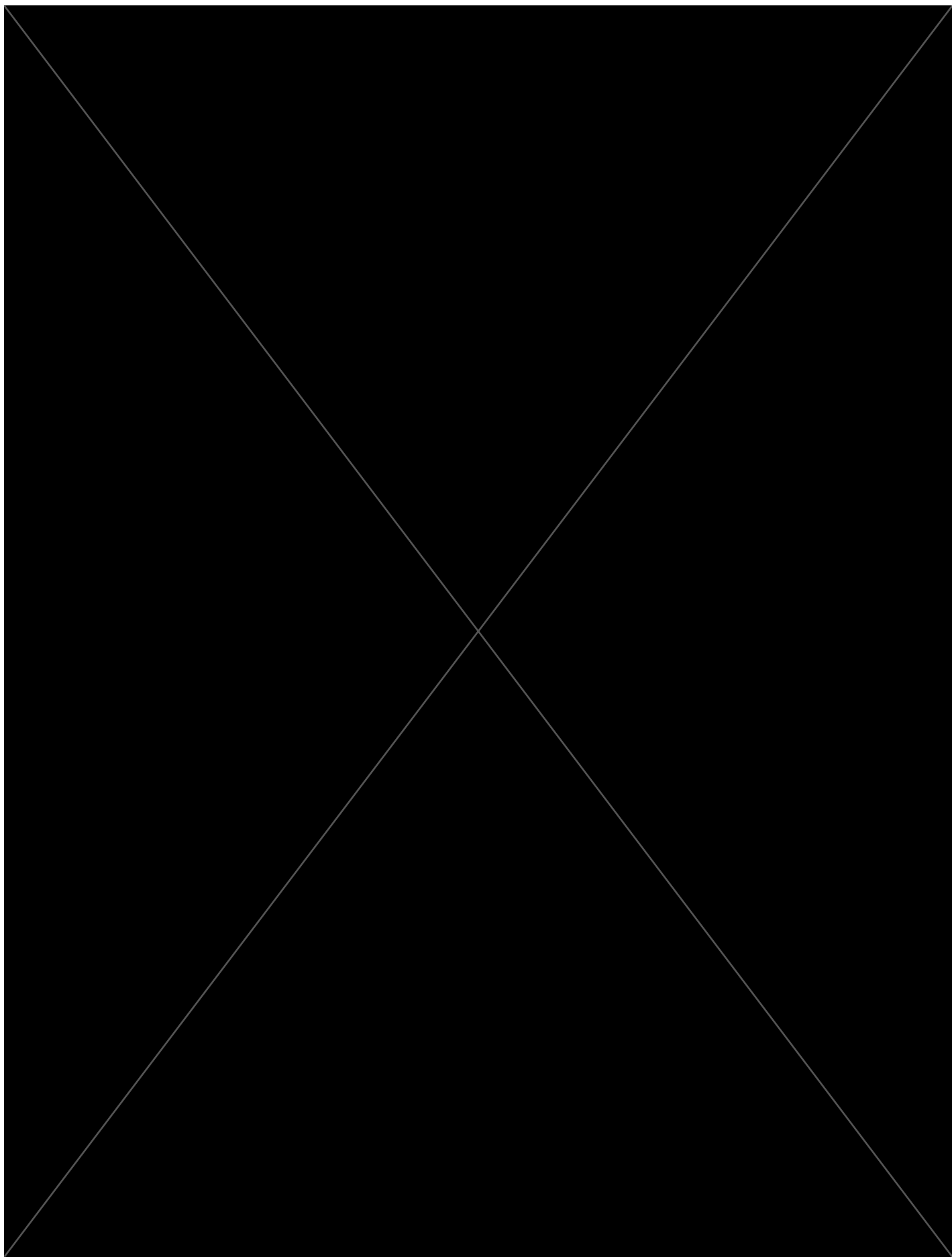
Student members believe in the mission (4.5 out of 5), trust that leadership is setting a positive example (4.5), and would recommend the club to others (4.5). We also got a Cronbach's alpha of 0.965, meaning the data is real and reliable and the issues found were important to address.

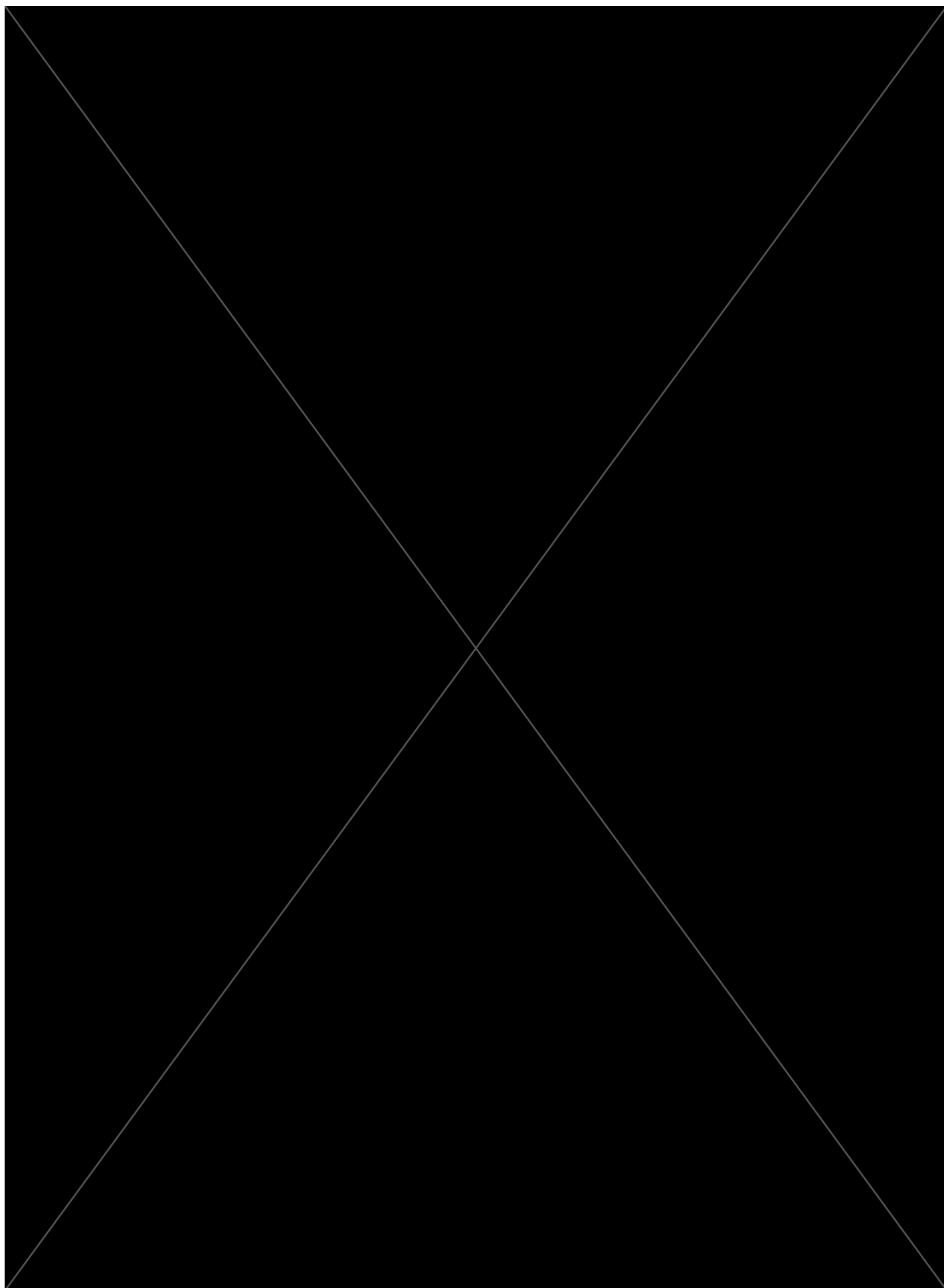
The recommendations we proposed are designed to handle all those three issues. 

Appendix A – Item-Level Descriptive Statistics









Appendix E – Citations

Sources Used

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